

EXPEDITORS

Engineering Kickoff Day

Git & GitHub Fundamentals

Audience: New Coding/DevOps bootcamp students

Focus: Only the core concepts and commands they need on Day 1

Module 1 — The Git Mental Model

Goal: Understand what Git *does* before touching commands.

Topics

- Why version control exists
- Local vs. remote
- The three areas:
 - **Working Directory**
 - **Staging Area**
 - **Repository**
- The three commands they'll use constantly:
 - `git status`
 - `git add`
 - `git commit`

Mini-Lab

- Create a folder
- `git init`
- Make a file → stage → commit
- Check history

Module 2 — Everyday Git Workflow

Goal: Build comfort with the basic cycle of editing → staging → committing.

Topics

- Editing files and committing changes
- Checking what changed (`git diff`)

- Viewing commit history (git log)
- .gitignore basics (just what it is)

Mini-Lab

- Make multiple commits
- Explore diffs
- Add a .gitignore entry

Module 3 — GitHub Fundamentals

Goal: Push code to GitHub and pull it back down.

Topics

- What GitHub provides
- Creating a GitHub repo
- Connecting local → remote
- Pushing (git push)
- Pulling (git pull)
- Cloning (git clone)

Mini-Lab

- Create a GitHub repo
- Connect local repo
- Push first commit
- Pull changes
- Clone a repo

Module 4 — Branching Basics

Goal: Understand branches enough to not fear them.

Topics

- What a branch is
- Why branches exist
- Creating and switching branches
- Merging a branch back into main
- Very light mention of merge conflicts (awareness only)

Mini-Lab

- Create a branch
- Make a change
- Merge it back

Module 5 —Collaboration Preview (NO LAB)

Goal: Give just enough context for future collaboration lessons.

Topics (high-level only)

- What a Pull Request is
- What “main” is
- Why teams use branches
- Why PRs exist (no workflow details)